

Whales in danger

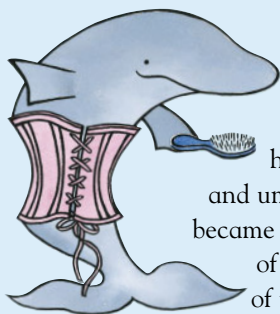
In the past, fishermen used to hunt whales. So many died that there are hardly any left of some species. One of the problems is that their rate of reproduction is slow, so it is hard for them to recover from major losses.

Current danger

Whales are no longer hunted on a large scale, but they are threatened by our waste products. They become entangled in discarded fishing nets and suffer from oil spills. They are also exposed to pollution released into the sea from factories.

Are whales still caught?

Most countries have stopped whaling, but some continue to catch whales for scientific study. This ship has caught a minke whale and is pulling it up on deck.



AND ALL FOR A BRUSH...

In the 1800s and 1900s, one of the products that people wanted from whales was baleen. It was used for hair and floor brushes, combs, corsets, and umbrella frames. Its use gradually became unnecessary with the development of nylon, but it resulted in the deaths of thousands of whales.

